

Shufflr, Indian based startup offers online video services

If you're bored for lack of videos online, and are just too tired to search online, look no further. Described by its developers as a "social video browser that helps discover online videos using your social graph", Shufflr helps you find, share and collect videos from across the web.

You can browse through videos shared and liked by your friends on Facebook, Twitter and other contacts using Shufflr's Adobe AIR-based video browser. Additionally, Shufflr uses "SMART" filters to recommend online videos from all over the web, including YouTube, Hulu, MetaCafe, Comedy Central, New York Times, depending on your personal preferences.

After you enjoy a video and have rated it, Shufflr will recommend a list of videos using its "SMART association engines" that present similar videos.

This social video browser, developed by Althea Systems – an India-based startup, acts like a platform for you to discover, view, share and collect videos from all over the web. Apart from watching videos that your contacts on Facebook and Twitter have shared with you via its social video feed, you can follow also follow other people Shufflr recommends to you. These recommendations are based on similar tastes, and viewing patterns and preferences.

On the downside, what this also implies is that Shufflr collects information about you as well, and lets other Shufflr users see what you're watching. If that really isn't your cup of tea, then



you can still go ahead and watch a video anonymously.

Other significant features include intelligent search. This uses information from your profile related to what you've searched and liked before, and

improves search result relevance. Shufflr has been around for more than six months now, having launched in mid 2010, and has been meeting much success lately, in no small part due to its simplicity and speed of

getting started. The AIR-based GUI is quite intuitive to use, and not too demanding of your system. The download itself is quite lightweight, about 3MB, but requires AIR installed on your system before hand. **[i]**

Intel Insider: get Hollywood and Bollywood digital content on your PC with Sandy Bridge

After Intel launched Core processors last year, it has now launched its new line of Sandy Bridge processors and associated video/graphics. It has now gone a step further and arranged for HD content for its digital content service.

Subscribers of Intel's Insider service will now be able to download, purchase or rent movies and videos in full 1080p HD quality, and view them on their 2011 Core-powered laptops and desktops. Since Intel Insider supports Wi-Di 2.0 (Wireless Display) technology, you will also be able to wire-

lessly stream content from your laptop to your HDTV.

Intel has tied up with major players such as CinemaNow, Dixons Retail, Image Entertainment, Sonic Solutions, Warner Bros. Digital Distribution, as well as Hungama Digital Media Entertainment to deliver content to its customers.

While it still not clear whether the content will be hosted on an Intel Insider portal or available from certified sites, you can be sure that Intel will be able to entice more content providers in the months ahead. What Intel is probably looking at is "End to End Hardware Pro-

tection". Simply put, your purchased/rented content is hardware locked to your computer.

This also entices providers and distributors to release HD video digital content on the same date (or even earlier) as DVD/Blu-ray releases.

According to Intel, "Commercial distribution of HD premium content using the Intel Insider technology is expected to begin during the first quarter of 2011, and services will be available in Q1." Although we're still waiting for the widespread adoption of DTH services in India, we're looking forward to this one. **[i]**